

Testimony

By: Bob Phillips, Lebanon County Board of Commissioners, Chairman

Chairman Grove, Chairman Conklin and State Government Committee members, I am Commissioner Bob Phillips, Chair of the Lebanon County Board of Commissioners and a business owner in Lebanon.

I am here to urge that Lebanon County remain whole in a Congressional District, preferably in Congressional District 9. We are currently a part of Congressional District 9 and Congressman Dan Meuser has given us excellent service.

Lebanon County has 141,793 residents according to the 2020 census. A perfect Congressional district is 764,865 under the new census.

So, for Lebanon County to have any real clout in a Congressional District it needs to remain whole. Even whole, the county is only 19% of a Congressional District. There is an important reason for Lebanon County to remain whole. We have three facilities in our county important to National Defense and for our veterans. They are the Lebanon Veterans Administration Medical Center, Fort Indiantown Gap, and the Fort Indiantown Gap National Cemetery. Combined the three facilities employs over 3,000 area residents.

The Fort is one of the largest training facilities for National Guard and Army Reserve soldiers in the country. It was used as a staging facility for World War II divisions and was used for the same staging purpose for recent conflicts such as Enduring Freedom and Iraqi Freedom.

All three facilities are interrelated and if that county remains whole, one Congressional District will serve all three.

So important are these facilities to our National Defense and our Veterans that in a prior Congressional re-appointment process, military and community leaders asked our then State Senator to draw the existing Congressman out of the County because he was unpopular with his fellow Congressman, and they feared our facilities would be targeted for closure.

For the above stated reasons, I respectfully ask you to keep Lebanon County whole in one Congressional District.